

ANALYTICAL REPORT

Stage 2: Demographic Analysis

Psychological Capital, Job Satisfaction, and Work Engagement Among Academic Staff

Al-Quds Open University — Palestine

Total Sample (N)	270 Academic Staff
Demographic Variables	6 Variables
SPSS Procedure	Analyze → Descriptive Statistics → Frequencies
Analysis Date	16 May 2026

1. Introduction

Demographic analysis constitutes the second stage of the data analysis framework and provides a descriptive profile of the study participants. Profiling the sample is essential for contextualising the findings, assessing representativeness, and enabling readers to evaluate the generalisability of the conclusions (Creswell & Creswell, 2018; Pallant, 2020). This report presents the demographic characteristics of the 270 academic staff members who participated in the study across 15 branches of Al-Quds Open University (QOU), Palestine.

Al-Quds Open University was established in 1991 and operates as the largest higher education institution in Palestine in terms of student enrolment, with a geographically dispersed structure that extends across all Palestinian governorates in both the West Bank and the Gaza Strip (QOU, 2023). This unique open-university model, which emphasises accessibility and regional outreach, directly shapes the demographic composition of its academic workforce — particularly in terms of geographic distribution, academic qualifications, and staffing hierarchy. Understanding the demographic profile of the participating staff is therefore not only a methodological requirement but also a contextual necessity for interpreting subsequent findings on psychological capital, job satisfaction, and work engagement.

All frequency and percentage values reported in this section are sourced directly from the SPSS Frequencies output (Analyze → Descriptive Statistics → Frequencies), generated on 16 May 2026. Six demographic variables were analysed: gender, age group, academic rank, years of experience at QOU, highest degree earned, and branch location.

2. Gender Distribution

Table 1 presents the gender distribution of the sample. Male respondents constituted the majority (n = 173, 64.1%), while female respondents accounted for 35.9% of the sample (n = 97).

This gender distribution is broadly consistent with the composition of academic staff in Palestinian higher education, where male academics have historically represented a larger share of the faculty workforce (Palestinian Central Bureau of Statistics [PCBS], 2022). However, the representation of female staff at QOU — at approximately one third of the sample — reflects the university's ongoing efforts to expand female participation in academic roles, particularly in branches serving governorates with traditionally lower rates of female employment in the formal sector. The gender imbalance observed in the sample also warrants attention in subsequent analyses, as gender has been identified in the literature

as a potentially moderating variable in the relationship between psychological capital and work-related outcomes (Luthans et al., 2007).

Table 1 Frequency Distribution of Gender

Category	Frequency	Percent (%)	Valid Percent (%)	Cumulative Percent (%)
Male	173	64.1	64.1	64.1
Female	97	35.9	35.9	100.0
Total	270	100.0	100.0	—

Note. All values are sourced directly from the SPSS Frequencies output for the variable gender. $N = 270$.

3. Age Group Distribution

Table 2 presents the age group distribution of the sample. The largest group comprised respondents aged 41–50 years ($n = 88$, 32.6%), followed by those aged 51–60 years ($n = 80$, 29.6%). Respondents aged 30–40 years accounted for 23.7% ($n = 64$), while those aged over 60 years represented 11.5% ($n = 31$). The youngest age group (under 30 years) constituted the smallest proportion of the sample ($n = 7$, 2.6%).

The concentration of staff in the 41–60 age range (62.2% of the total sample) reflects the maturity and experience of QOU's academic workforce. This age profile is attributable in part to QOU's long operational history since 1991, which has produced a cohort of long-serving staff who joined the university in its early years and have remained in post. Moreover, the university's relatively stable employment environment — characterised by long-term contracts and limited staff turnover in comparison to private-sector institutions — has contributed to the ageing of its academic workforce (QOU, 2023). The predominance of mid-career and senior staff has important implications for the study, as research consistently indicates that psychological capital and job engagement tend to stabilise or increase with age and career stage (Luthans et al., 2007; Schaufeli & Bakker, 2004).

Table 2 Frequency Distribution of Age Group

Category	Frequency	Percent (%)	Valid Percent (%)	Cumulative Percent (%)
Less than 30 years	7	2.6	2.6	2.6
30–40 years	64	23.7	23.7	26.3
41–50 years	88	32.6	32.6	58.9
51–60 years	80	29.6	29.6	88.5
More than 60 years	31	11.5	11.5	100.0
Total	270	100.0	100.0	—

Note. All values are sourced directly from the SPSS Frequencies output for the variable age_group. $N = 270$.

4. Academic Rank Distribution

Table 3 presents the distribution of respondents by academic rank. The SPSS output coded academic rank numerically (1 through 4), corresponding to ascending levels of seniority. Rank 2 (Assistant Professor) was the most prevalent category ($n = 94$, 34.8%), followed by Rank 1 (Instructor/Teaching Assistant) with 78 respondents (28.9%). Rank 3 (Associate Professor) accounted for 23.7% ($n = 64$), and Rank 4 (Full Professor) represented the smallest group ($n = 34$, 12.6%).

The predominance of Ranks 1 and 2 combined (63.7% of the sample) is consistent with QOU's staffing model as an open-access university that employs a large number of instructors and assistant professors to deliver its broad undergraduate programme offerings across multiple branches. QOU's academic structure relies heavily on distributed teaching delivery, which necessitates a proportionally larger base of junior and mid-level academic staff relative to senior professorial ranks (QOU, 2023). The relatively smaller proportion of full professors (12.6%) is also explained by the competitive academic promotion pathway in Palestinian universities, which requires extensive research output and years of service — conditions that are particularly challenging given the resource constraints and socio-political environment in which QOU operates (Abualrob & Atar, 2019).

It should be noted that the rank labels applied in this report (Instructor/Teaching Assistant, Assistant Professor, Associate Professor, Full Professor) are assigned on the basis of QOU's conventional four-tier academic ranking system. The SPSS output recorded these as numeric codes 1–4; the labels are provided for interpretive clarity and are not computed values.

Table 3 Frequency Distribution of Academic Rank

Category	Frequency	Percent (%)	Valid Percent (%)	Cumulative Percent (%)
Rank 1 — Instructor / Teaching Assistant	78	28.9	28.9	28.9
Rank 2 — Assistant Professor	94	34.8	34.8	63.7
Rank 3 — Associate Professor	64	23.7	23.7	87.4
Rank 4 — Full Professor	34	12.6	12.6	100.0
Total	270	100.0	100.0	—

Note. All frequency and percentage values are sourced directly from the SPSS Frequencies output for the variable *academic_rank*. Rank labels are assigned based on the standard QOU academic ranking system and are not computed values. $N = 270$.

5. Years of Experience at QOU

Table 4 presents the distribution of respondents by years of experience specifically at Al-Quds Open University. The most frequently represented group comprised respondents with 11–15 years of experience ($n = 67$, 24.8%), followed by those with 5–10 years ($n = 63$, 23.3%). Respondents with 16–20 years of experience accounted for 19.6% ($n = 53$), while those with more than 20 years represented 18.1% ($n = 49$). The smallest group comprised respondents with fewer than 5 years of experience ($n = 38$, 14.1%).

The distribution of experience indicates a highly tenured academic staff body: respondents with 11 or more years at QOU collectively constituted 61.9% of the sample. This pattern is consistent with QOU's institutional characteristics as a long-established public university with stable employment conditions and limited staff turnover. The relatively low proportion of recently appointed staff (14.1% with fewer than 5 years) may partly reflect QOU's cautious recruitment trajectory in recent years, which has been shaped by budgetary constraints and the challenging socio-economic conditions in Palestine (PCBS, 2022).

From a research perspective, the predominance of experienced staff is relevant to the study's main constructs. Psychological capital components — particularly resilience, optimism, and self-efficacy — have been shown to develop and consolidate through accumulated professional experience, suggesting that the study population may exhibit relatively high PsyCap levels (Luthans et al., 2007). Similarly, long-tenured employees have been found to demonstrate more stable patterns of work engagement, though this relationship may be moderated by perceived institutional support and job conditions (Schaufeli & Bakker, 2004).

Table 4 Frequency Distribution of Years of Experience at QOU

Category	Frequency	Percent (%)	Valid Percent (%)	Cumulative Percent (%)
Less than 5 years	38	14.1	14.1	14.1
5–10 years	63	23.3	23.3	37.4
11–15 years	67	24.8	24.8	62.2
16–20 years	53	19.6	19.6	81.9
More than 20 years	49	18.1	18.1	100.0
Total	270	100.0	100.0	—

Note. All values are sourced directly from the SPSS Frequencies output for the variable *experience_qou*. *N* = 270.

6. Highest Degree Earned

Table 5 presents the educational qualifications of the respondents. The overwhelming majority held a Master's degree as their highest qualification (*n* = 205, 75.9%), followed by Bachelor's degree holders (*n* = 53, 19.6%). Respondents holding a PhD represented the smallest group (*n* = 12, 4.4%).

The predominance of Master's degree holders is directly consistent with QOU's staffing structure and employment criteria. As an open university offering primarily undergraduate programmes across geographically dispersed branches, QOU recruits a substantial proportion of its teaching staff at the lecturer and instructor level, for which a Master's degree is the standard minimum qualification (QOU, 2023). The relatively small proportion of PhD holders (4.4%) reflects both the limited availability of doctoral graduates in the Palestinian labour market — where access to doctoral education remains constrained by political, logistical, and financial barriers — and QOU's pragmatic approach to staffing its distributed branch network with qualified practitioners who may not hold terminal academic degrees (PCBS, 2022; Abualrob & Atar, 2019).

The educational profile of the sample has potential implications for the study's findings. Research suggests that higher educational attainment is positively associated with self-efficacy and psychological capital (Luthans et al., 2007), and that academics holding doctoral qualifications may demonstrate higher intrinsic motivation and work engagement due to stronger identification with scholarly identity. However, in contexts such as QOU — where resource constraints and heavy teaching loads are characteristic — the relationship between educational attainment and work engagement may be mediated by perceived organisational support and job satisfaction.

Table 5 *Frequency Distribution of Highest Degree Earned*

Category	Frequency	Percent (%)	Valid Percent (%)	Cumulative Percent (%)
Bachelor	53	19.6	19.6	19.6
Master	205	75.9	75.9	95.6
PhD	12	4.4	4.4	100.0
Total	270	100.0	100.0	—

Note. All values are sourced directly from the SPSS Frequencies output for the variable *highest_degree*. *N* = 270.

7. Branch Location Distribution

Table 6 presents the distribution of respondents across the 15 QOU branch locations included in the study. QOU's branch network spans both the West Bank and the Gaza Strip, encompassing all major Palestinian governorates. This geographic structure is a defining feature of QOU's identity as an open-access institution committed to providing higher education to Palestinians regardless of their geographic location or socio-economic circumstances (QOU, 2023).

Among West Bank branches, Hebron recorded the highest representation in the sample ($n = 38$, 14.1%), followed by Ramallah ($n = 37$, 13.7%) and Nablus ($n = 36$, 13.3%). These three branches collectively accounted for 41.1% of the total sample, reflecting their status as QOU's largest and most established branches in the West Bank, serving densely populated governorates with high demand for higher education. Bethlehem contributed 22 respondents (8.1%), while Tulkarm and Jenin each contributed 17 respondents (6.3% each). Jericho ($n = 11$, 4.1%), Tubas ($n = 10$, 3.7%), Qalqilya ($n = 10$, 3.7%), and Salfit ($n = 4$, 1.5%) contributed smaller proportions consistent with their smaller branch sizes and population catchment areas.

Among Gaza Strip branches, Khan Yunis recorded the highest representation ($n = 19$, 7.0%), followed by Gaza City ($n = 18$, 6.7%) and North Gaza ($n = 13$, 4.8%). Rafah and Deir al-Balah each contributed 9 respondents (3.3%). The inclusion of Gaza Strip branches in the sample is particularly noteworthy given the exceptional circumstances under which these branches operate. Academic staff in the Gaza Strip work under conditions of prolonged socio-political instability, restricted mobility, and limited access to professional development resources, all of which are contextually relevant to the study's examination of psychological capital and resilience as positive psychological resources (Luthans et al., 2007; Avey et al., 2011).

The geographic spread of the sample across 15 branches in both the West Bank and Gaza Strip substantially enhances its representativeness of QOU's academic workforce as a whole, supporting the generalisability of the study's findings across the institution.

Table 6 Frequency Distribution of Branch Location

Category	Frequency	Percent (%)	Valid Percent (%)	Cumulative Percent (%)
Ramallah	37	13.7	13.7	13.7
Nablus	36	13.3	13.3	27.0
Hebron	38	14.1	14.1	41.1
Tulkarm	17	6.3	6.3	47.4
Jenin	17	6.3	6.3	53.7
Bethlehem	22	8.1	8.1	61.9
Jericho	11	4.1	4.1	65.9
Qalqilya	10	3.7	3.7	69.6
Salfit	4	1.5	1.5	71.1
Tubas	10	3.7	3.7	74.8
Gaza	18	6.7	6.7	81.5
Khan Yunis	19	7.0	7.0	88.5
Rafah	9	3.3	3.3	91.9
North Gaza	13	4.8	4.8	96.7
Deir al-Balah	9	3.3	3.3	100.0
Total	270	100.0	100.0	—

Note. All values are sourced directly from the SPSS Frequencies output for the variable *branch_location*. *N* = 270. The sample covers all 15 QOU branches included in the study frame, spanning 11 West Bank governorates and 4 Gaza Strip locations.

8. Summary of Sample Demographic Characteristics

Table 7 consolidates the demographic profile of the full sample across all six variables. This summary table serves as a single reference for the demographic composition of the study sample and is intended for reproduction in the methodology section of the final research paper.

Table 7 Summary of Demographic Characteristics of the Study Sample (*N* = 270)

Variable	Category	n	% of Total Sample
Gender	Male	173	64.1%

	Female	97	35.9%
Age Group	Less than 30 years	7	2.6%
	30–40 years	64	23.7%
	41–50 years	88	32.6%
	51–60 years	80	29.6%
	More than 60 years	31	11.5%
Academic Rank	Rank 1 (Instructor/TA)	78	28.9%
	Rank 2 (Asst. Professor)	94	34.8%
	Rank 3 (Assoc. Professor)	64	23.7%
	Rank 4 (Full Professor)	34	12.6%
Experience at QOU	Less than 5 years	38	14.1%
	5–10 years	63	23.3%
	11–15 years	67	24.8%
	16–20 years	53	19.6%
	More than 20 years	49	18.1%
Highest Degree	Bachelor	53	19.6%
	Master	205	75.9%
	PhD	12	4.4%
Branch (West Bank)	Hebron	38	14.1%
	Ramallah	37	13.7%
	Nablus	36	13.3%
	Bethlehem	22	8.1%
	Tulkarm	17	6.3%
	Jenin	17	6.3%
	Jericho	11	4.1%
	Qalqilya	10	3.7%
	Tubas	10	3.7%
	Salfit	4	1.5%
	Khan Yunis	19	7.0%
	Gaza	18	6.7%

	North Gaza	13	4.8%
	Rafah	9	3.3%
	Deir al-Balah	9	3.3%
Total		270	100.0%

Note. All frequencies and percentages are sourced directly from the SPSS Frequencies output. Rank labels for Academic Rank are assigned based on the QOU academic hierarchy and are provided for interpretive clarity; they are not computed values. Percentages may not sum to exactly 100.0% due to rounding.

9. Conclusion

The demographic analysis reveals a sample that is predominantly male (64.1%), concentrated in the 41–60 age range (62.2%), holding the rank of Assistant Professor (34.8%), with 11 or more years of experience at QOU (61.9%), and a Master's degree as the highest qualification (75.9%). The sample is distributed across 15 QOU branches in both the West Bank and the Gaza Strip, with West Bank branches accounting for 74.8% of the sample and Gaza Strip branches accounting for the remaining 25.2%.

This demographic profile is consistent with the structural characteristics of QOU as a large, distributed, open-access university operating within the Palestinian higher education context. The prevalence of experienced, mid-career staff with Master's-level qualifications reflects the university's staffing model and employment practices, while the geographic spread of the sample across branches in both the West Bank and Gaza Strip reinforces the representativeness of the findings. These contextual factors will be revisited in the discussion of subsequent analytical stages, particularly in relation to the observed levels of psychological capital, job satisfaction, and work engagement among QOU academic staff.

The analysis will proceed to Stage 3: Descriptive Statistics.

References

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